THOT

Introduction

The Egyptian God Thot (or Thoth or Toth), who is thought to be the equivalent of the Greek Hermes, the first alchemist, with the divine task of preparing certain alchemic substances. The only human people who could practice this holy, divine and sacred art were the priests, who were thought to be sons of Thot.

Game background

In this game, the players - alchemists face each other in order to survive and eliminate the opponents. By using alchemical substances produce effects, either offensive or defensive.

Game cards

The game consists of cards, each representing a unique alchemical substance with a unique ability. To apply an effect, **2 cards are required** with an exception of special cards where only **1 is required**.

Players and game preparation

All players have **Health Points** and **Defense Points**. At start, all players have **7 Health Points** and **0 Defense Points**. Both these points increase or decrease over the game course. Each Health or Defense points **cannot exceed 7**. The players can be from **2 to 8,** either as individuals or teams. Each game lasts approximately between **10 to 15** minutes. All players sit in a circle and all cards are shuffled. All players agree who the first player will be (commonly the one who shuffles the deck) in order to determine the clockwise round. The players can play either solitary or form teams. The size of each team must be the same. The players sit in a closed circle position but for team games, players of the same team cannot sit side by side. All players keep their cards secret, have **7** health points and **0** defence points in their player sheet. When all players have exactly **7** cards, the deck is kept in the middle of the circle, and the game preparation phase ends.

Battle

The battle consists of clockwise rounds, starting from the first player of each circle. All cards are kept close by each player. The game sheet of each player is visible to all. Each player has one of the four options to play on his round.

- **Construct an effect** (2 cards are required) and apply effects on self or another player. The played cards then go to the bottom of the deck. If a player has only 1 card left, he may pass and take a card from the deck.
- **Pass** – Take a card from the deck if there are cards on it.
- **Donate 1 card** to another player.

Crafting

There are **105** total cards on the deck. Each card represents an alchemic substance with various effects. There are **5** groups of cards, and each group has **2** subgroups by organizing the effects:

 **Tinkering (defensive effects)**

- ⊙ **Defend (10 cards)** – Add Defence Points to self or opponent.
- ☆ **Influence (9 cards)** – Take a card from top of the deck

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Brewery (healing effects)

Cure (12 cards) – Add Health Points to self or opponent.

Speed (8 cards) – Play again immediately. 2 Speed cards have the same effect as 1 card (play again for 1 time).

Herbalism (features)

Sleep (8 cards) – Lose next round – If opponent has lost his round, this component has no effect. 2 Sleep cards have the same effect as 1 card (lose only 1 round).

Hypnotise (8 cards) – Return random card to the bottom of the deck.

Poison (attacking effects)

Harm (32 cards) – Inflict damage – Decrease Defence Points and/or Health Points

Steal (12 cards) – Steal random card from opponent – If he has no cards, this component has no effect.

Special ingredients (various effects)

The Mirror (2 cards) – All effects by caster are returned immediately to him. This card can be should as a defence by an attacker.

The Void (2 cards) – All effects by caster are halted and have no effects. This card should be used as a defence by an attacker.

Reflection (2 cards) – All effects by caster are returned immediately to another player. This card should be used as a defence by an attacker.

Special cards

Special cards cannot be used as ingredients and are always kept secret for the other players. A special card is used only by a defended player when attacked by another one (**even if it is not his time to play**) as a trap. However, a special card over one or more special cards are permitted (e.g., a mirror over a mirror over a void card where the firstly attacking caster is inflicted by the effects of his round play).

Health points, Defence points and Damage

Each player can increase his (or a teammates') health or defense points by using cards (they cannot exceed 7). Upon damage, the player inflicted the damage decrease firstly the defense points and when they are equal to zero, the health points. When health points are zero, the player is dead and out of the game, returning. A dead player returns all his cards to the bottom of the central deck. For team games, the dead player cards are returned to the team players who decide which card would be acquired by whom, as his legacy.

Ending

Last player to survive (the only player with not zero health points) is the winner. Respectively, the team with the last survival player wins.

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